



CHESS TACTICS FOR KIDS

Learn the Pieces, Master the Moves,
and Win with Smart Tactics!

By **Kunal Saha**
Birati Chess Academy

A friendly first chess book for young players

Chess Tactics for Kids

Author: Kunal Saha

Published by: Birati Chess Academy

Copyright © 2026 Kunal Saha & Birati Chess Academy.
All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, distributed, or transmitted in any form or by any means, including photocopying, recording, or other electronic or mechanical methods, without the prior written permission of the author, except for brief quotations in a review.

This book is intended for educational purposes to help young learners enjoy and understand the game of chess.

WELCOME

Hello, Young Chess Champion!

Chess is one of the oldest and most exciting games in the world — and now it's your turn to learn it! In this book, you will meet all six chess pieces, discover how each one moves, learn simple, powerful tactics that even grandmasters use, meet some of the greatest players in history, and even get to color your own chess pictures!

Did you know? Chess is played by millions of people around the world, and it has been around for over 1,500 years!

So grab a chessboard, your favorite color pencils, and let's begin our journey from the very first square to your very first winning tactic.



HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

Your Chess Adventure Map

Every topic in this book follows the same fun pattern, so you'll always know what's coming next:

 **Lesson** — learn something new about chess with pictures and simple words.

 **Quiz Time** — test what you learned with fun questions. Answers are upside-down at the bottom — no peeking!

 **Coloring Page** — grab your color pencils and decorate your very own chess pieces.

At the end, you'll meet famous chess champions, solve extra puzzles, learn chess notation, try some fun activities, and even earn a certificate. Ready? Let's go!

CONTENTS

What's Inside

Getting Started

01 The Chessboard

02 Meet the Chess Pieces

The Six Pieces

03 The King

04 The Queen

05 The Rook

06 The Bishop

07 The Knight

08 The Pawn

09 Piece Point Values

10 The Starting Position

Famous Chess Players

11 Jose Raul Capablanca

12 Mikhail Tal

13 Bobby Fischer

14 Garry Kasparov

15 Viswanathan Anand

16 Judit Polgar

17 Magnus Carlsen

18 Gukesh Dommaraju

Chess Tactics

19 What is a Tactic?

20 The Fork

21 The Pin

22 The Skewer

23 Discovered Attack

24 Double Attack

25 Back Rank Mate

26 Smothered Mate

27 Removing the Defender

Winning & Drawing

28 Checkmate Basics

29 Stalemate & Draws

Level Up

30 Reading & Writing Chess Notation

31 Opening Principles

32 Chess Etiquette

33 Famous Games in History

Practice Zone

34 Practice Puzzles

35 Puzzle Solutions

36 Fun Chess Facts

37 Top Tips for Young Players

Activities & Fun

38 Chess Word Search

39 Match the Piece

40 Coloring Gallery

41 My Chess Journal

The End

42 Certificate of Achievement

43 About the Author & Academy

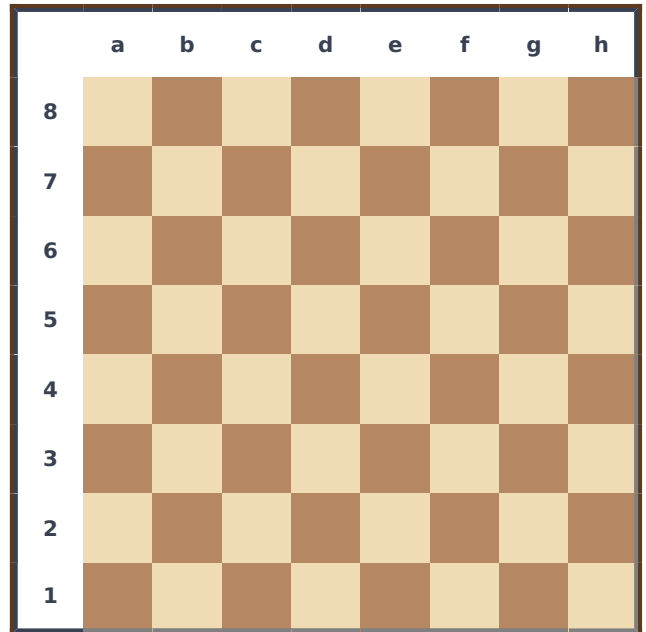
CHAPTER 1

The Chessboard

A chessboard has **64 squares** arranged in an 8×8 grid, with alternating light and dark squares.

- Vertical columns are called **files**, labeled **a-h**.
- Horizontal rows are called **ranks**, numbered **1-8**.
- Every square has its own address, like **e4** or **c7**.
- Always set up the board with a **light square** in the bottom-right corner!

Remember: "Light on right" helps you set up the board correctly every time.



The Chessboard — Quiz Time!

Let's see what you remember!

1. How many squares are on a chessboard?

- ☐ a 32
- ☐ b 64
- ☐ c 100

2. What are the vertical columns called?

- ☐ a Ranks
- ☐ b Files
- ☐ c Rows

3. Which square color goes in the bottom-right corner?

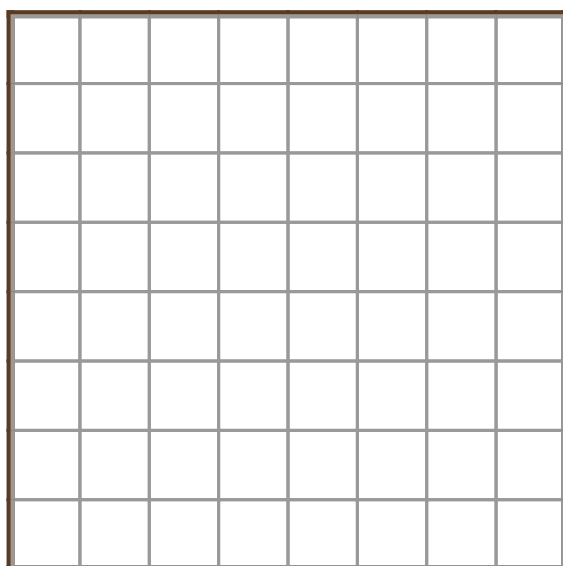
- ☐ a Dark
- ☐ b Light
- ☐ c Either one

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-b, 2-b, 3-b

Color the Chessboard

Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!



Color the squares to make your own pattern — try stripes, rainbows, or a classic checkerboard!

CHAPTER 3

Meet the Chess Pieces

Every chess army has **16 pieces**: 1 King, 1 Queen, 2 Rooks, 2 Bishops, 2 Knights, and 8 Pawns. Let's meet each one before we learn how they move!



King

The most important piece



Queen

The most powerful piece



Rook

The castle-shaped piece



Bishop

The diagonal traveler



Knight

The jumping horse



Pawn

The small but mighty soldier

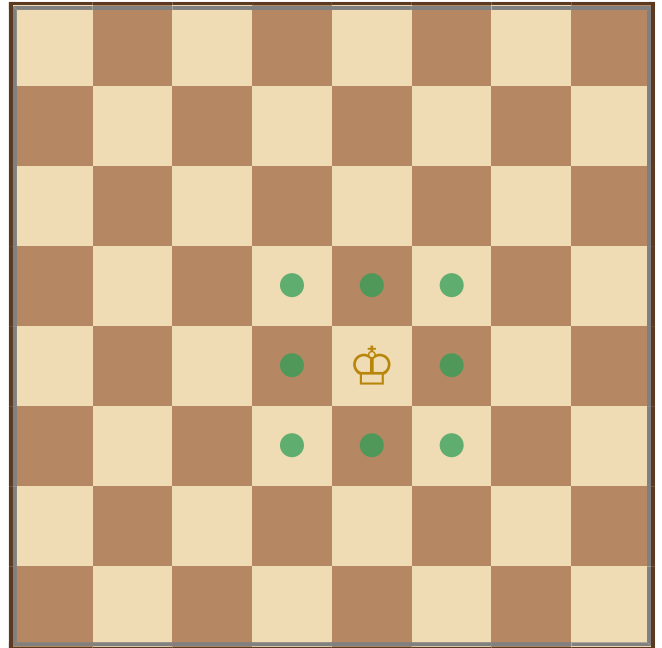
Fun fact: Each player starts with exactly the same set of pieces — that's what makes chess a fair game of skill!

Point Value: Priceless — protect it always!

How it Moves

The King moves just **1 square in any direction** — up, down, sideways, or diagonally. He may be slow, but the whole game revolves around keeping him safe. If your King is trapped and under attack with no escape, that's **checkmate** and the game ends!

Fun fact: The King is never actually captured in chess — the game ends the moment checkmate happens.



The King — Quiz Time!

Let's see what you remember!

1. How many squares can the King move at a time?

- ☐ a As many as it wants
- ☐ b Only 1
- ☐ c Only 2

2. What happens when the King is trapped with no escape?

- ☐ a Stalemate
- ☐ b Checkmate
- ☐ c Nothing

3. Can the King move diagonally?

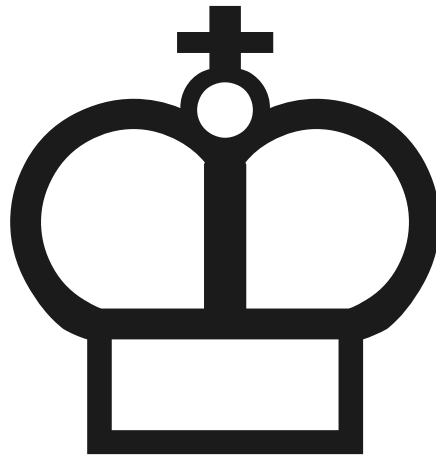
- ☐ a Yes
- ☐ b No
- ☐ c Only on Tuesdays

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-b, 2-b, 3-a

Color the King

Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!



This is the King ♀ — give it your favorite colors!

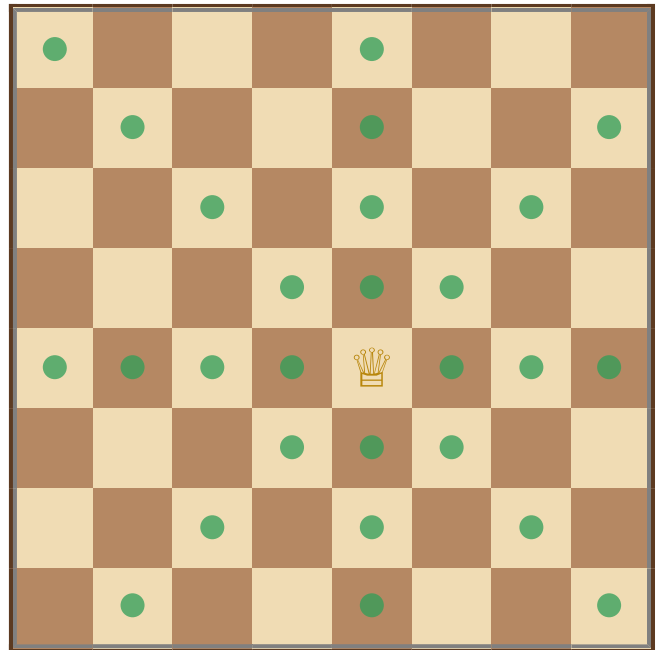
The Queen

Point Value: 9 points

How it Moves

The Queen is the most powerful piece on the board. She can move **any number of squares** in a straight line — horizontally, vertically, or diagonally. Combining a Rook's and Bishop's powers makes her incredibly dangerous!

Fun fact: The Queen wasn't always this powerful — in medieval chess she could only move one square diagonally!



The Queen — Quiz Time!

Let's see what you remember!

1. How many points is the Queen worth?

- ☐ a 5
- ☐ b 9
- ☐ c 3

2. Which two pieces' powers does the Queen combine?

- ☐ a King & Pawn
- ☐ b Rook & Bishop
- ☐ c Knight & Rook

3. Can the Queen jump over pieces?

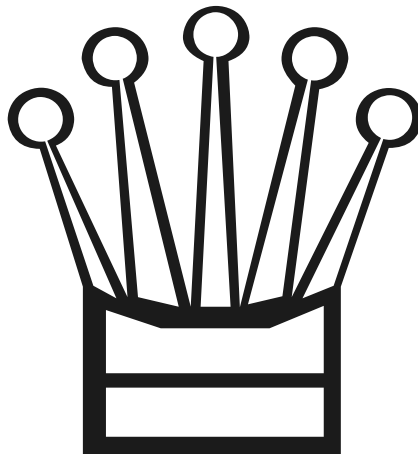
- ☐ a Yes
- ☐ b No
- ☐ c Only Knights can

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-b, 2-b, 3-b

Color the Queen

Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!



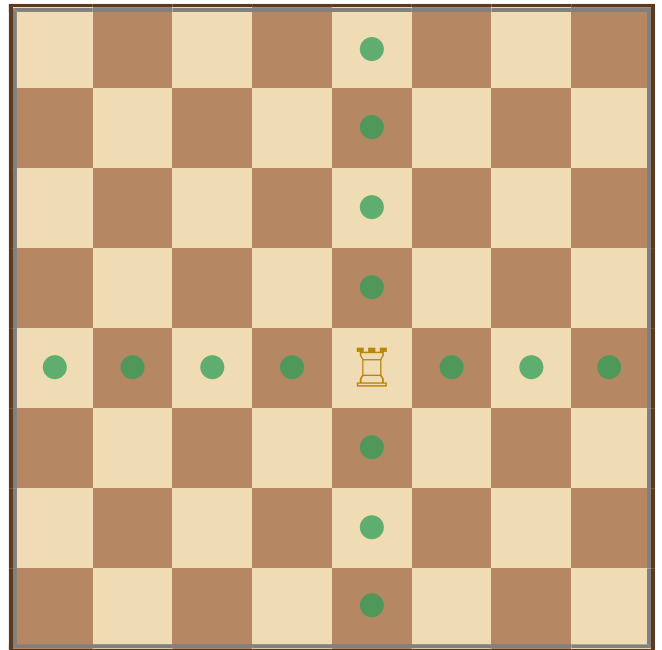
This is the Queen 👑 — give it your favorite colors!

Point Value: 5 points

How it Moves

The Rook moves in **straight lines** — forward, backward, left, or right — for as many open squares as it likes. Rooks are extra powerful when they work together on an open file.

Fun fact: The Rook is shaped like a castle tower, and its name comes from an old Persian word for 'chariot'!



The Rook — Quiz Time!

Let's see what you remember!

1. How many points is a Rook worth?

- ☐ a 3
- ☐ b 5
- ☐ c 9

2. Which directions can a Rook move?

- ☐ a Diagonal only
- ☐ b Straight lines only
- ☐ c L-shape

3. What shape does a Rook look like?

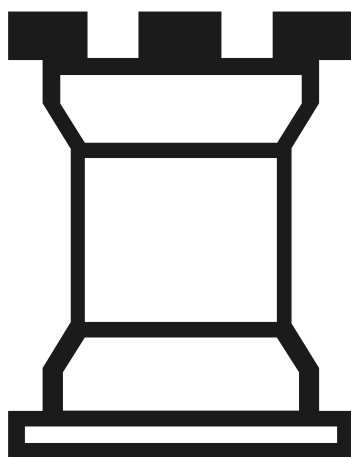
- ☐ a A horse
- ☐ b A castle tower
- ☐ c A crown

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-b, 2-b, 3-b

Color the Rook

Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!



This is the Rook ♖ — give it your favorite colors!

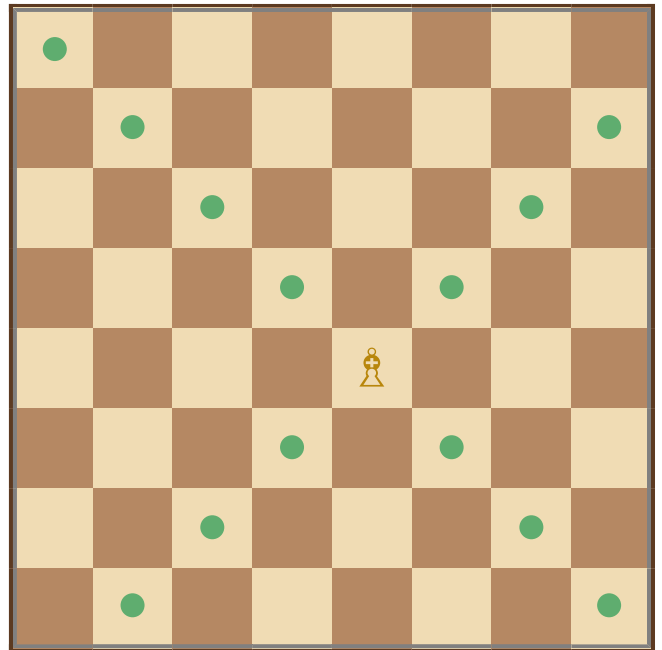
The Bishop

Point Value: 3 points

How it Moves

The Bishop moves **only diagonally**, but it can travel any number of squares. Each Bishop stays on the same color square for the whole game — one Bishop lives on light squares, the other on dark squares.

Fun fact: Because each Bishop is stuck to one color, two Bishops working together can control the whole board!



The Bishop — Quiz Time!

Let's see what you remember!

1. How does a Bishop move?

- ☐ a Straight lines
- ☐ b Diagonally
- ☐ c L-shape

2. How many points is a Bishop worth?

- ☐ a 3
- ☐ b 5
- ☐ c 1

3. Does a Bishop ever change square color?

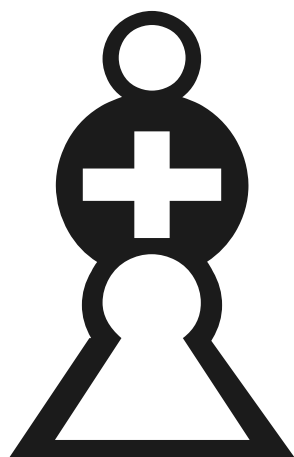
- ☐ a Yes, every move
- ☐ b Never
- ☐ c Only when captured

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-b, 2-a, 3-b

Color the Bishop

Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!



This is the Bishop ♖ — give it your favorite colors!

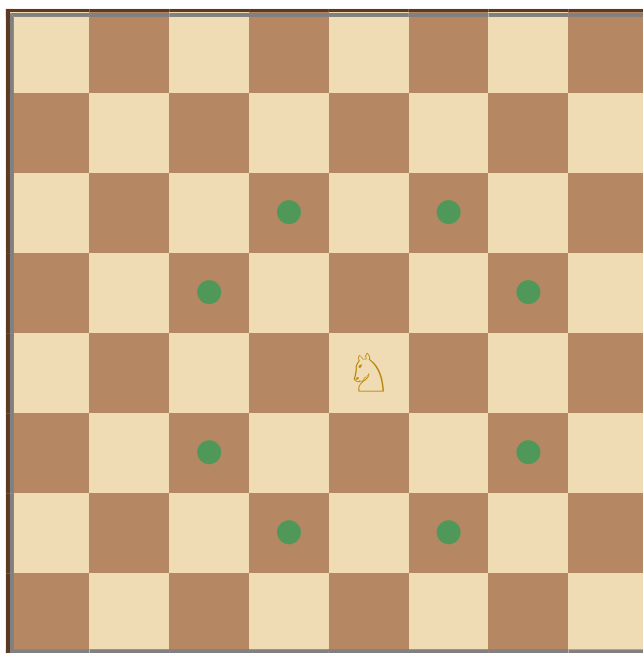
The Knight

Point Value: 3 points

How it Moves

The Knight moves in a special **L-shape**: two squares in one direction, then one square sideways (or one square then two sideways). It is the only piece that can **jump over** other pieces!

Fun fact: Because Knights jump, they love crowded, blocked positions where other pieces get stuck!



The Knight — Quiz Time!

Let's see what you remember!

1. What shape does the Knight move in?

- ☐ a Straight line
- ☐ b L-shape
- ☐ c Diagonal

2. What special ability does the Knight have?

- ☐ a Jumping over pieces
- ☐ b Moving backward only
- ☐ c Capturing the King

3. How many points is a Knight worth?

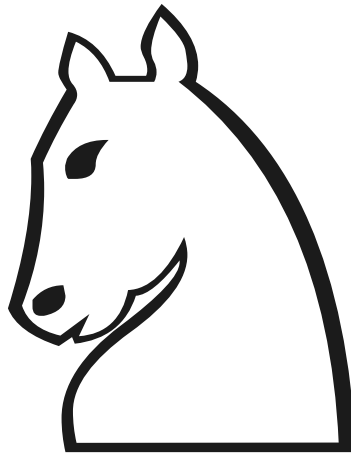
- ☐ a 3
- ☐ b 5
- ☐ c 9

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-b, 2-a, 3-a

Color the Knight

Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!



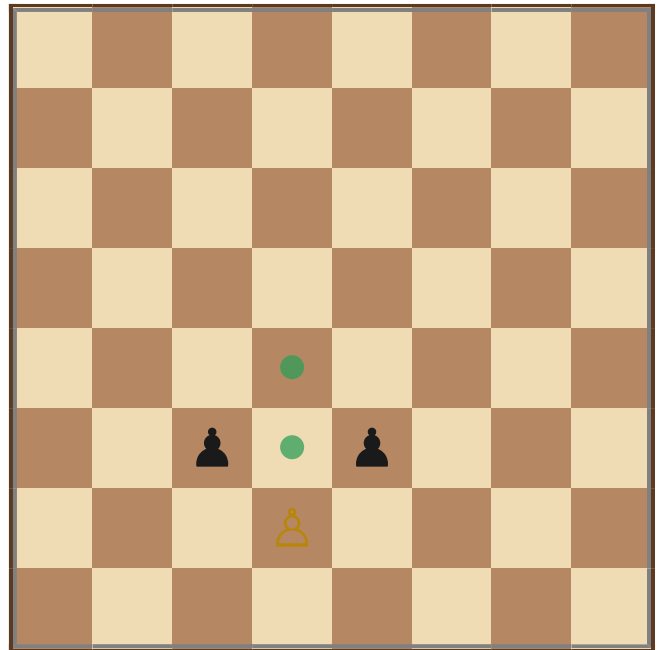
This is the Knight ♞ — give it your favorite colors!

Point Value: 1 point

How it Moves

Pawns move **forward one square** at a time (two squares on their very first move), but they **capture diagonally** — one square forward-left or forward-right. Pawns can never move backward!

Fun fact: If a Pawn reaches the very last rank, it can **promote** into any piece you choose — usually a Queen!



The Pawn — Quiz Time!

Let's see what you remember!

1. How does a Pawn capture?

- ☐ a Straight ahead
- ☐ b Diagonally
- ☐ c Backward

2. What can a Pawn become when it reaches the last rank?

- ☐ a Nothing
- ☐ b Any piece (usually a Queen)
- ☐ c Only a Rook

3. Can a Pawn ever move backward?

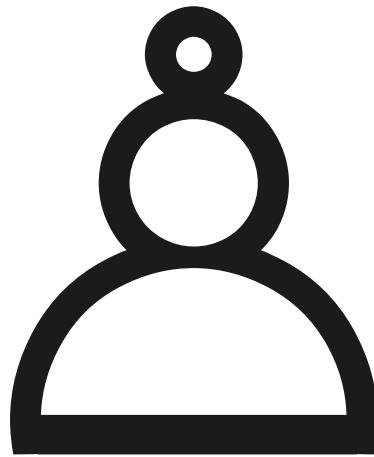
- ☐ a Yes
- ☐ b No
- ☐ c Only when capturing

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-b, 2-b, 3-b

Color the Pawn

Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!



This is the Pawn ♙ — give it your favorite colors!

CHAPTER 16

Piece Point Values

Point values help you decide whether a trade is good or bad. Higher-value pieces are more powerful, so try not to trade a strong piece for a weaker one!

	Piece	Point Value	How it Moves
	King	Priceless — protect it always!	1 square in any direction
	Queen	9 points	Any distance, any direction
	Rook	5 points	Straight lines: up, down, left, right
	Bishop	3 points	Diagonal lines only
	Knight	3 points	L-shape jump (2+1 squares)
	Pawn	1 point	1 square forward (2 on first move); captures diagonally

Smart tip: Never trade your Queen (9 points) for a Pawn (1 point) — always think about the value before you capture!

Piece Point Values — Quiz Time!

Time to test your point-value knowledge!

1. Which piece is worth the most points?

- ☐ (a) Rook
- ☐ (b) Queen
- ☐ (c) Bishop

2. How many points is a Knight worth?

- ☐ (a) 1
- ☐ (b) 3
- ☐ (c) 5

3. True or False: The King has a point value.

- ☐ (a) True
- ☐ (b) False — priceless!
- ☐ (c) 50 points

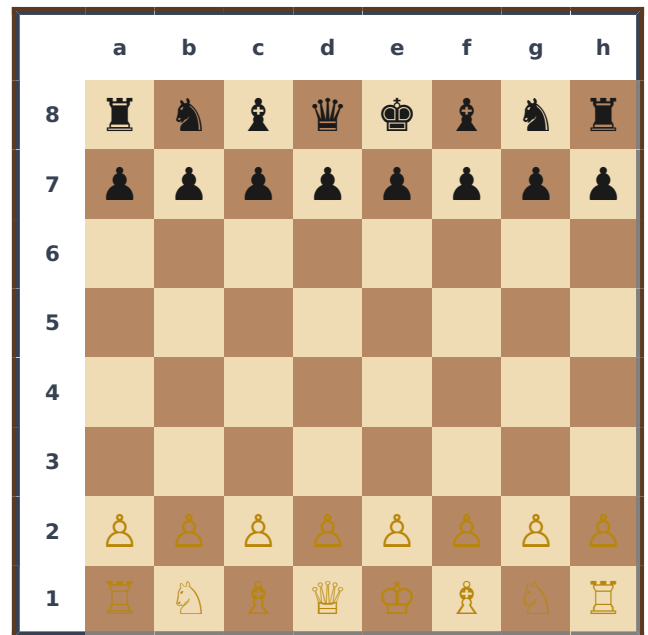
turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-b, 2-b, 3-b

The Starting Position

Every chess game begins the same way. Here's how to set up the board:

- Rooks go in the **corners**.
- Knights stand **next to the Rooks**.
- Bishops stand **next to the Knights**.
- The Queen goes on **her own color** (white Queen on a light square).
- The King takes the **last central square**.
- Pawns form a wall across the **second rank**.



Memory trick: "Queen loves her own color!"

Starting Position — Quiz Time!

Can you remember the setup?

1. Which piece goes in the corners?

- ☐ a Knight
- ☐ b Rook
- ☐ c Bishop

2. Where does the white Queen start?

- ☐ a A dark square
- ☐ b A light square
- ☐ c Anywhere

3. Which rank do all the Pawns start on (for White)?

- ☐ a 1st
- ☐ b 2nd
- ☐ c 4th

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-b, 2-b, 3-b

CHAMPIONS

Famous Chess Players

Chess has been played by brilliant minds for hundreds of years. Here are some of the most legendary champions in history — maybe one day *your* name will be added to a list just like this one!



José Raúl Capablanca

1888 - 1942 • World Champion 1921-1927 • Cuba



Capablanca was famous for his effortless, natural playing style. He made the game look so easy that people called him "**The Human Chess Machine.**" He went years without losing a single game!

Fun fact: As a young child, Capablanca learned chess just by watching his father play — nobody taught him the rules!

FAMOUS CHESS PLAYERS

Mikhail Tal

1936 - 1992 • World Champion 1960 • Latvia (USSR)



Known as "**The Magician from Riga**," Tal loved bold, daring attacks and surprising piece sacrifices that confused even the strongest opponents.

Fun fact: Tal once said he sometimes sacrificed pieces without knowing exactly how the attack would work — and it still worked!

FAMOUS CHESS PLAYERS

Bobby Fischer

1943 - 2008 • World Champion 1972 • United States



Fischer became a chess grandmaster at just 15 years old. In 1972, he defeated Boris Spassky in a match so famous it was nicknamed the "**Match of the Century.**"

Fun fact: Fischer taught himself chess from books, reportedly learning Russian just to read Soviet chess magazines!

FAMOUS CHESS PLAYERS

Garry Kasparov

Born 1963 • World Champion 1985-2000 • Russia



Kasparov became the youngest World Champion at just 22 years old. He is also famous for his historic matches against the IBM supercomputer **Deep Blue**.

Fun fact: Kasparov is considered one of the greatest players ever, known for his fierce, aggressive style.

FAMOUS CHESS PLAYERS

Viswanathan Anand

Born 1969 • World Champion 2000, 2007-2013 • India



Anand was India's first Grandmaster and became a national hero, inspiring millions of young Indian players to pick up chess.

Fun fact: Anand is nicknamed "**The Lightning Kid**" because of how fast he calculates moves at the board!

FAMOUS CHESS PLAYERS

Judit Polgar

Born 1976 • Strongest female player in history • Hungary



Judit Polgar became a Grandmaster at just 15 years old — faster than even Bobby Fischer! She defeated many World Champions during her incredible career.

Fun fact: Judit and her sisters were homeschooled by their father specifically to become chess champions — and it worked!

FAMOUS CHESS PLAYERS

Magnus Carlsen

Born 1990 • World Champion 2013-2023 • Norway



Carlsen is widely considered one of the greatest players of all time. He has held the World No. 1 rating for most of the time since 2011.

Fun fact: Magnus was nicknamed the "**Mozart of Chess**" as a child because of his natural talent.

FAMOUS CHESS PLAYERS

Gukesh Dommaraju

Born 2006 • World Champion since 2024 • India



Gukesh became the World Chess Champion in December 2024 at just 18 years old, making him the **youngest World Champion in history**.

Fun fact: Gukesh is from Chennai, India — proof that with practice and passion, young players can reach the very top!

Famous Chess Players — Quiz Time!

How well do you know the champions?

1. Who became World Champion at just 18 years old in 2024?

- ☐ (a) Magnus Carlsen
- ☐ (b) Gukesh Dommaraju
- ☐ (c) Bobby Fischer

2. Which player was nicknamed "The Magician from Riga"?

- ☐ (a) Mikhail Tal
- ☐ (b) Judit Polgar
- ☐ (c) Capablanca

3. Who was India's first Grandmaster?

- ☐ (a) Gukesh Dommaraju
- ☐ (b) Viswanathan Anand
- ☐ (c) Garry Kasparov

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-b, 2-a, 3-b

What is a Chess Tactic?

A **tactic** is a clever, short-term trick that helps you win material (capture a piece) or even checkmate your opponent. Great chess players are always looking for tactics on every move!

Think of tactics as **secret combos** — just like in your favorite video games, using the right combo at the right time can win the whole match!

In the next few chapters, you'll learn eight powerful tactics used by champions all over the world.

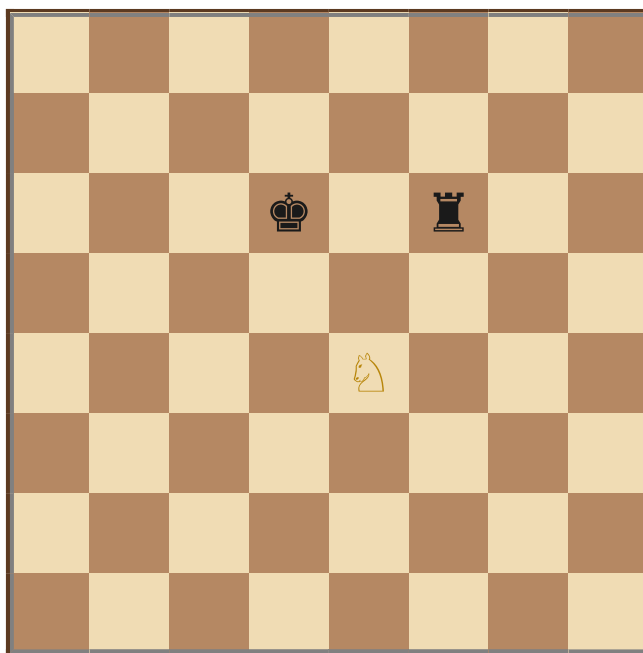
- **The Fork** — attack two pieces at once
- **The Pin** — trap a piece that can't move
- **The Skewer** — attack through one piece to the next
- **Discovered Attack** — move one piece to reveal another's attack
- **Double Attack** — threaten two targets with one piece
- **Back Rank Mate** — trap the King on the edge
- **Smothered Mate** — checkmate with a Knight, boxed in by friends
- **Removing the Defender** — take away the protector first

CHAPTER 31

The Fork

A **fork** happens when one piece attacks **two or more enemy pieces at the same time**. Knights are famous for forking because of their tricky L-shaped jump!

Fun fact: In the diagram, the white Knight (♠) attacks both the black King (♔) and the black Rook (♖) at once. The Rook cannot be saved!



The Fork — Quiz Time!

Test your tactic-spotting skills!

1. Which piece is famous for forking?

- ☐ a Knight
- ☐ b Bishop
- ☐ c King

2. A fork attacks how many pieces at once?

- ☐ a Just one
- ☐ b Two or more
- ☐ c Zero

3. In the example, which piece is lost to the fork?

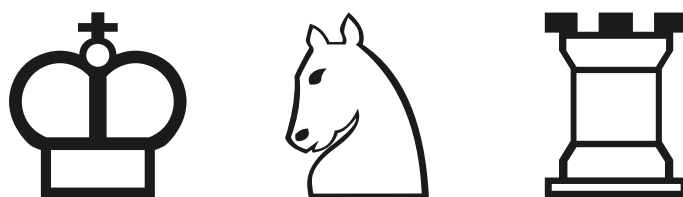
- ☐ a The King
- ☐ b The Rook
- ☐ c The Queen

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-a, 2-b, 3-b

Color the Board: The Fork

Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!

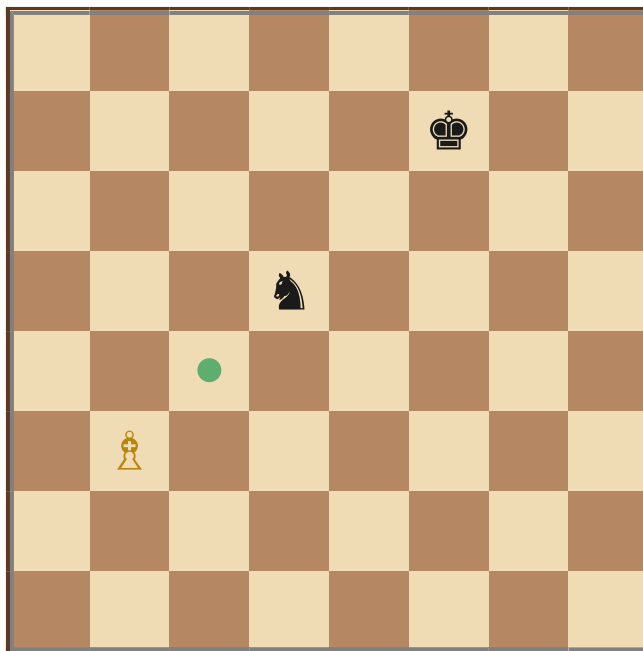


Draw your own version of the The Fork on a blank board, then color it in!

The Pin

A **pin** happens when a piece cannot move because doing so would expose a more valuable piece behind it — often the King — to attack.

Fun fact: The white Bishop (♗) pins the black Knight to the black King along the diagonal. The Knight is frozen and cannot move away!



The Pin — Quiz Time!

Test your tactic-spotting skills!

1. What does a pin prevent?

- ☐ a A piece from moving
- ☐ b A piece from capturing
- ☐ c Castling

2. A pin usually protects which piece behind it?

- ☐ a A Pawn
- ☐ b The King
- ☐ c Nothing

3. In the example, which piece is pinned?

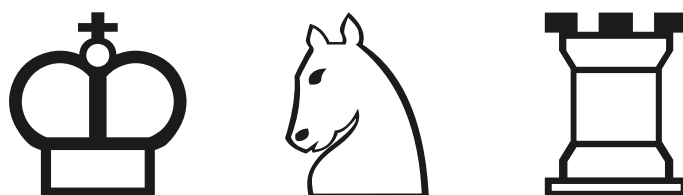
- ☐ a The Knight
- ☐ b The Bishop
- ☐ c The King

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-a, 2-b, 3-a

Color the Board: The Pin

Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!

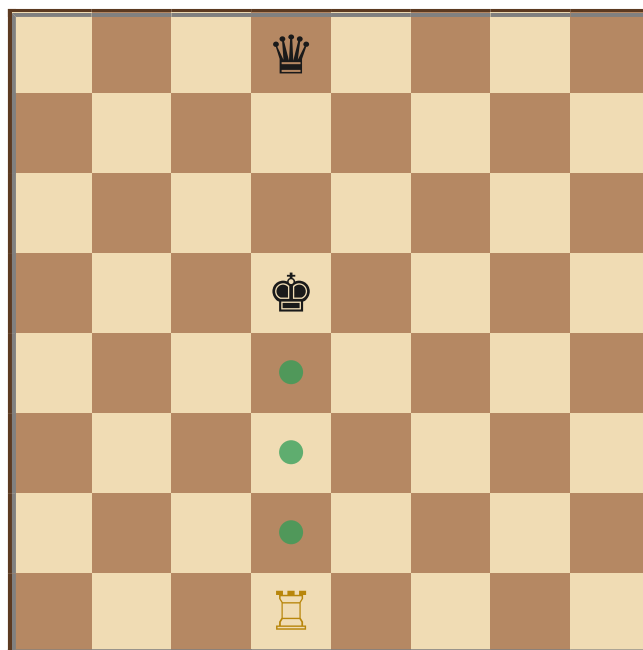


Draw your own version of the The Pin on a blank board, then color it in!

The Skewer

A **skewer** is like a reverse pin: a valuable piece is attacked first, and when it moves out of the way, a less valuable piece behind it gets captured.

Fun fact: The white Rook (♖) attacks the black King along the file. When the King moves, the black Queen behind it will be captured!



The Skewer — Quiz Time!

Test your tactic-spotting skills!

1. A skewer is often described as the opposite of what?

- ☐ a A fork
- ☐ b A pin
- ☐ c Castling

2. In a skewer, which piece is attacked first?

- ☐ a The less valuable one
- ☐ b The more valuable one
- ☐ c None

3. In the example, what gets captured after the King moves?

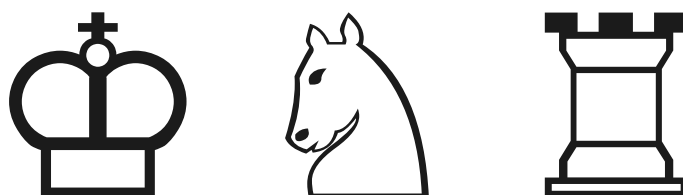
- ☐ a The Rook
- ☐ b The Queen
- ☐ c A Pawn

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-b, 2-b, 3-b

Color the Board: The Skewer

Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!

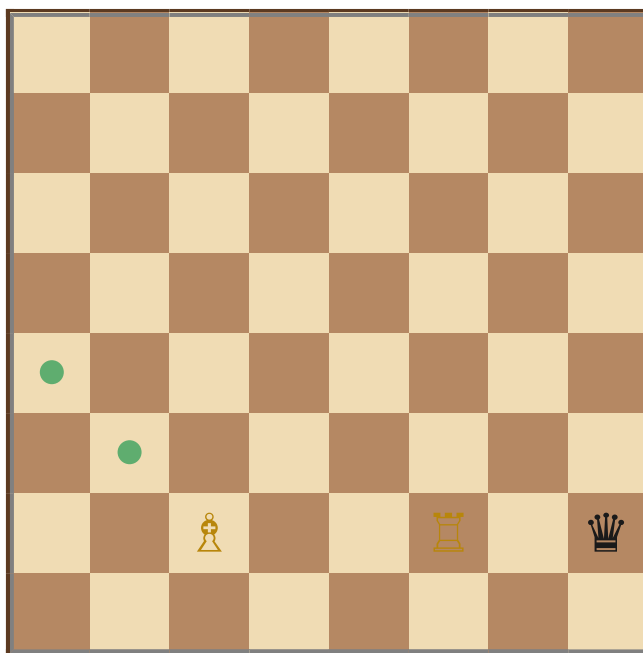


Draw your own version of the The Skewer on a blank board, then color it in!

Discovered Attack

A **discovered attack** happens when you move one piece out of the way, 'discovering' an attack from another piece hiding behind it.

Fun fact: The white Bishop (♗) moves aside, and suddenly the white Rook (♖) attacks the black Queen behind it!



Discovered Attack — Quiz Time!

Test your tactic-spotting skills!

1. A discovered attack happens when you move a piece to reveal what?

- ☐ (a) Another piece's attack
- ☐ (b) Nothing
- ☐ (c) A checkmate always

2. How many of your own pieces are usually involved in a discovered attack?

- ☐ (a) One
- ☐ (b) Two
- ☐ (c) Four

3. In the example, which piece reveals the attack?

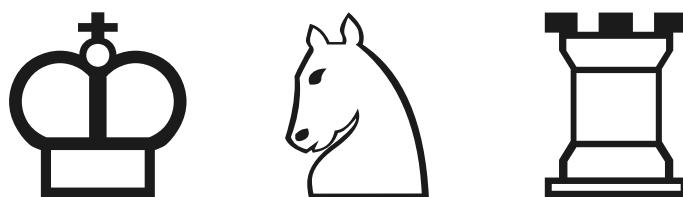
- ☐ (a) The Bishop
- ☐ (b) The Queen
- ☐ (c) The King

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-a, 2-b, 3-a

Color the Board: Discovered Attack

Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!

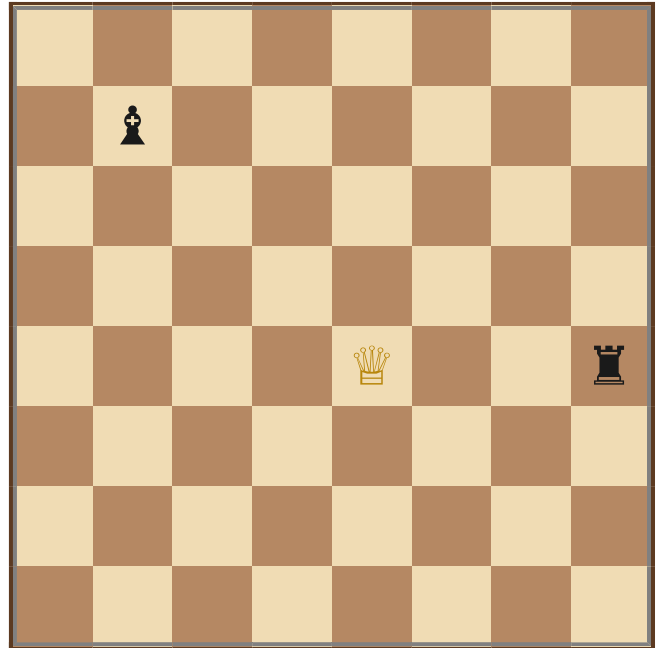


Draw your own version of the Discovered Attack on a blank board, then color it in!

Double Attack

A **double attack** is when a single piece threatens two enemy pieces or squares at the same time, so the opponent can only save one of them.

Fun fact: The white Queen (♙) attacks both the black Rook and the black Bishop in one move. Double trouble!



Double Attack — Quiz Time!

Test your tactic-spotting skills!

1. A double attack threatens how many things at once?

- ☐ a One
- ☐ b Two
- ☐ c Zero

2. Which piece is used in the example double attack?

- ☐ a Pawn
- ☐ b Queen
- ☐ c King

3. Why is a double attack so strong?

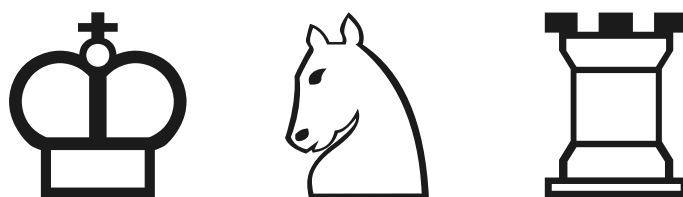
- ☐ a The opponent can only save one piece
- ☐ b It ends the game instantly
- ☐ c It's not strong

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-b, 2-b, 3-a

Color the Board: Double Attack

Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!

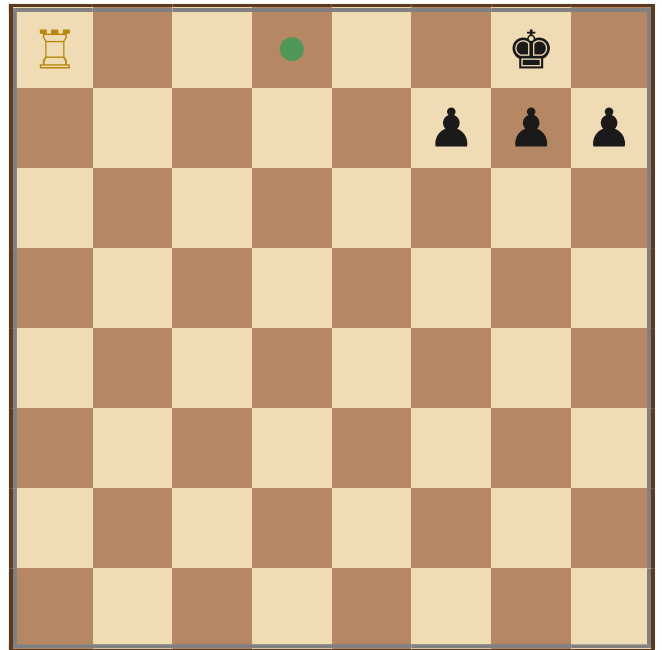


Draw your own version of the Double Attack on a blank board, then color it in!

Back Rank Mate

A **back rank mate** happens when a King is trapped on its home rank by its own Pawns, with no escape square, and a Rook or Queen delivers checkmate along that rank.

Fun fact: The black King is boxed in by its own Pawns on the 7th rank. The white Rook slides all the way down the open 8th rank — checkmate!



Back Rank Mate — Quiz Time!

Test your tactic-spotting skills!

1. What traps the King in a back rank mate?

- ☐ (a) Its own Pawns
- ☐ (b) The opponent's Queen
- ☐ (c) Nothing

2. Which pieces usually deliver a back rank mate?

- ☐ (a) Rook or Queen
- ☐ (b) Pawn
- ☐ (c) Bishop

3. How can you avoid a back rank mate in your own games?

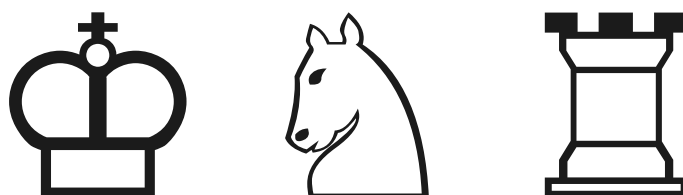
- ☐ (a) Make an escape square for your King
- ☐ (b) Move your Queen away
- ☐ (c) You can't avoid it

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-a, 2-a, 3-a

Color the Board: Back Rank Mate

Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!

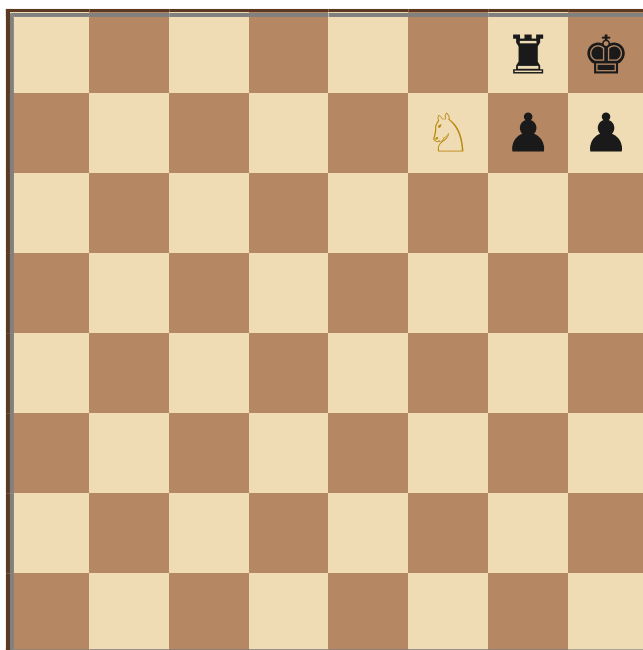


Draw your own version of the Back Rank Mate on a blank board, then color it in!

Smothered Mate

A **smothered mate** is a checkmate delivered by a Knight when the enemy King is completely surrounded (smothered) by its own pieces and cannot escape or block.

Fun fact: The black King is boxed in by its own Rook and Pawns. The white Knight (♠) jumps to deliver checkmate — the King has nowhere to go!



Smothered Mate — Quiz Time!

Test your tactic-spotting skills!

1. Which piece delivers a smothered mate?

- ☐ (a) Knight
- ☐ (b) Bishop
- ☐ (c) Rook

2. Why can't the King escape a smothered mate?

- ☐ (a) Its own pieces block every square
- ☐ (b) It's not in check
- ☐ (c) The board is too small

3. Is a smothered mate rare or common?

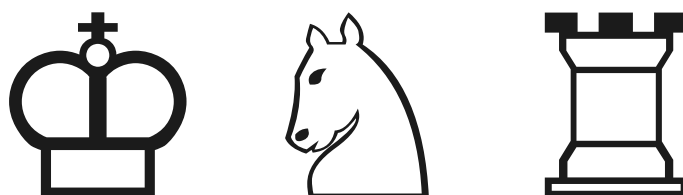
- ☐ (a) A rare, famous pattern
- ☐ (b) It happens every game
- ☐ (c) It's illegal

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-a, 2-a, 3-a

Color the Board: Smothered Mate

Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!

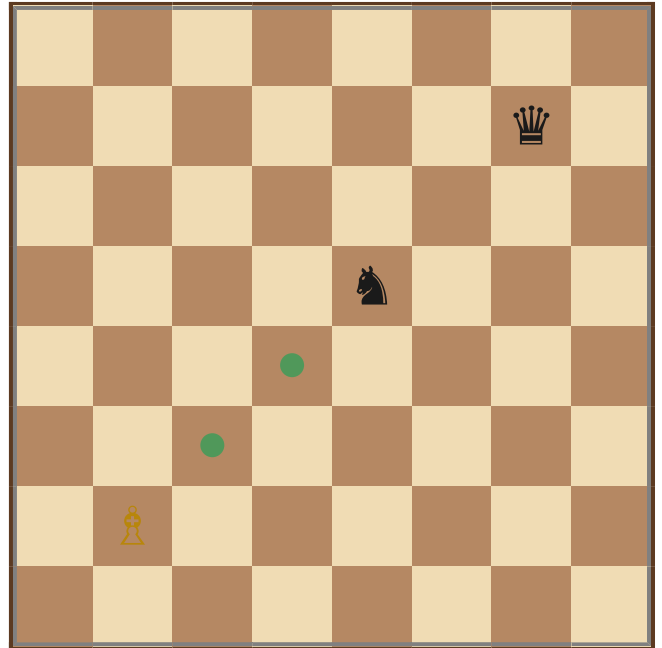


Draw your own version of the Smothered Mate on a blank board, then color it in!

Removing the Defender

Sometimes a valuable piece is protected by a defender. The **removing the defender** tactic captures that protector first, so the valuable piece can be won next.

Fun fact: The black Knight defends the black Queen. The white Bishop (♗) captures the Knight first — now the Queen has no protector!



Removing the Defender — Quiz Time!



Test your tactic-spotting skills!

1. What do you capture first in this tactic?

- ☐ a The defender
- ☐ b The King
- ☐ c A random Pawn

2. Why does removing the defender work?

- ☐ a It leaves the real target unprotected
- ☐ b It ends the game
- ☐ c It doesn't work

3. In the example, what was defending the Queen?

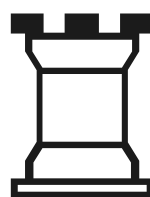
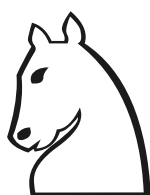
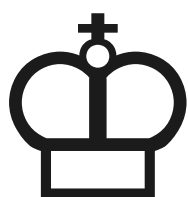
- ☐ a A Pawn
- ☐ b A Knight
- ☐ c A Rook

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-a, 2-a, 3-b

Color the Board: Removing the Defender

Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!

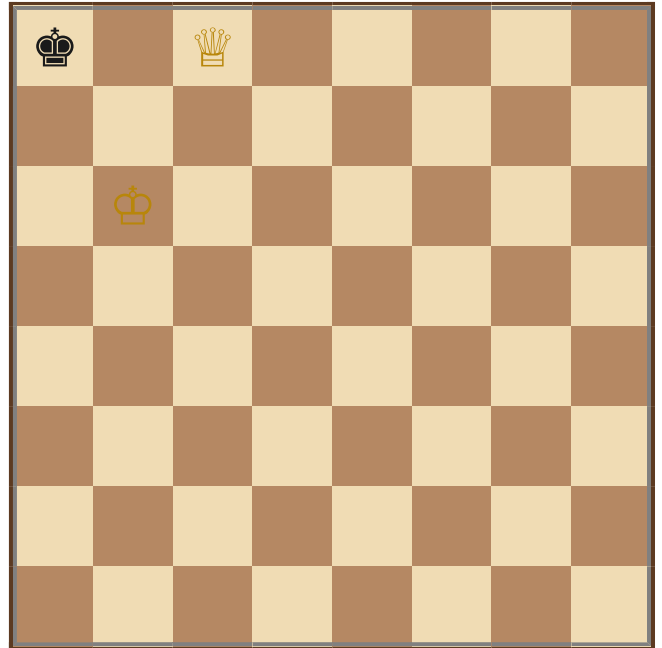


Draw your own version of the Removing the Defender on a blank board, then color it in!

Checkmate Basics

Checkmate happens when a King is under attack (in "check") and has **no legal way to escape** — it cannot move to a safe square, block the attack, or capture the attacker. When checkmate happens, the game is over!

Example: The black King is cornered. The white Queen gives check, and the white King controls the escape squares nearby. There's nowhere to go — checkmate!



Checkmate Basics — Quiz Time!

Let's check your checkmate knowledge!

1. What are the three ways to escape check?

- ☐ (a) Move, block, or capture
- ☐ (b) Cry, hide, run
- ☐ (c) There's no way to escape

2. What happens immediately when checkmate occurs?

- ☐ (a) Nothing
- ☐ (b) The game ends
- ☐ (c) You get an extra turn

3. Is the King ever actually captured in chess?

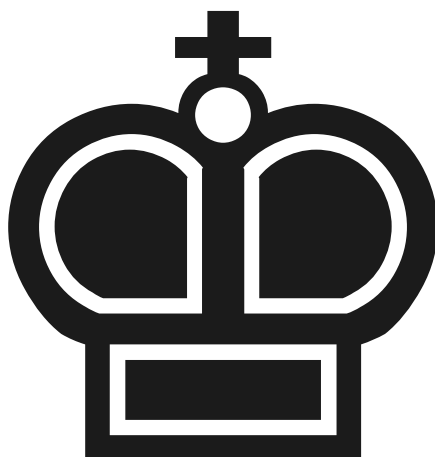
- ☐ (a) Yes, always
- ☐ (b) No, never
- ☐ (c) Only in blitz games

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-a, 2-b, 3-b

Color the King in Checkmate

Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!



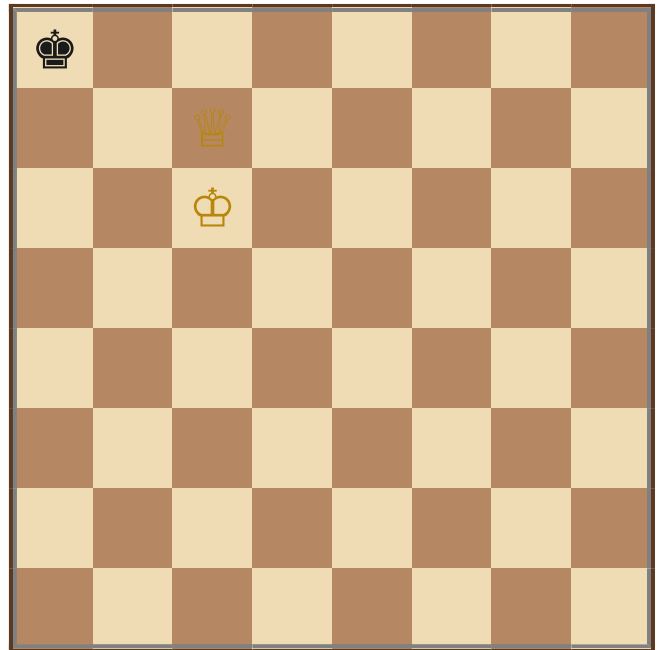
Draw a big crown and a sad or surprised face on this King — checkmate!

Stalemate & Draws

A **stalemate** happens when a player has **no legal moves** but their King is **not in check**. This results in a **draw** — nobody wins!

- Stalemate: no legal moves, King safe → draw.
- Checkmate: no legal moves, King attacked → game over, opponent wins.

Careful! Even if you're winning easily, watch out for accidentally trapping your opponent's King with no moves but no check — that throws away your win!



Stalemate & Draws — Quiz Time!

Draw or win? Let's find out!

1. What is the result of a stalemate?

- ☐ (a) White wins
- ☐ (b) Black wins
- ☐ (c) It's a draw

2. What's the key difference between checkmate and stalemate?

- ☐ (a) Whether the King is in check
- ☐ (b) The color of pieces
- ☐ (c) Nothing, they're the same

3. Should a winning player be careful about stalemate?

- ☐ (a) Yes
- ☐ (b) No
- ☐ (c) It doesn't matter

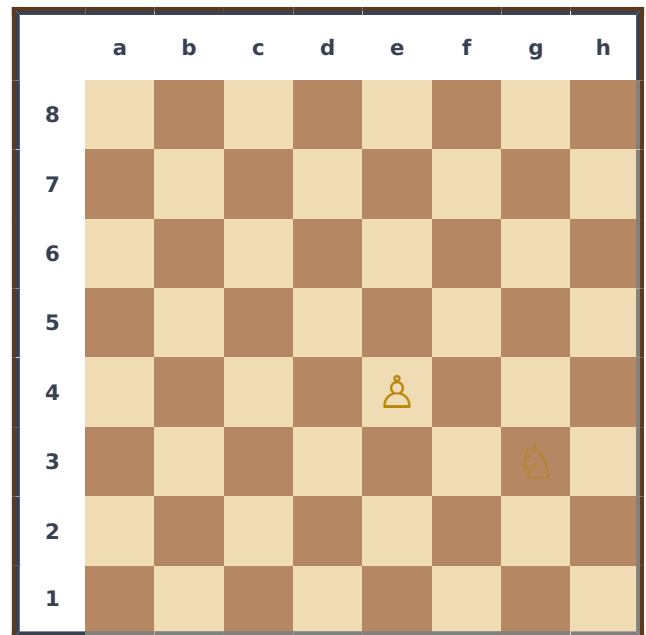
turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-c, 2-a, 3-a

Reading & Writing Chess Notation

Chess notation lets you write down every move in a game, just like a secret code!

- Each piece has a letter: **K**ing, **Q**ueen, **R**ook, **B**ishop, **N**ight (Knight).
- Pawns have no letter — just the square they move to.
- "e4" means a Pawn moved to square e4.
- "Nf3" means a Knight moved to square f3.
- "x" means a capture, like "Bxe5".
- "+" means check, and "#" means checkmate!



Example: 1. e4 ... Nf3

Chess Notation — Quiz Time!

Crack the code!

1. What letter stands for the Knight?

- ☐ a K
- ☐ b N
- ☐ c Kn

2. What symbol means "capture"?

- ☐ a +
- ☐ b x
- ☐ c #

3. What does "e4" tell you moved?

- ☐ a A Pawn to square e4
- ☐ b A King
- ☐ c Nothing

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-b, 2-b, 3-a

Practice Your Notation

Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!

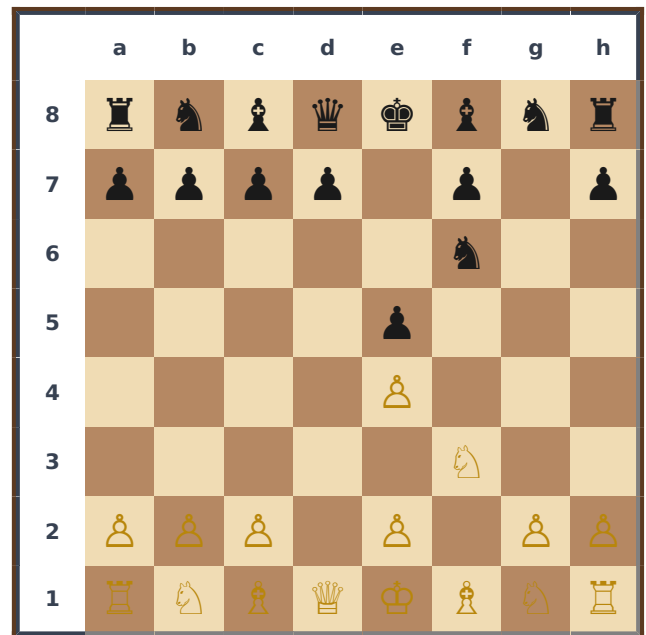
1 . e 4 e 5
2 . N f 3 N c 6

Trace over these famous opening moves, then write your own move below!

Opening Principles

The first few moves of a chess game are called the **opening**. Follow these golden rules to start every game strong:

- **Control the center** with a Pawn (like e4 or d4).
- **Develop your Knights and Bishops** early.
- **Castle** to keep your King safe.
- **Don't move the same piece twice** without a good reason.
- **Don't bring your Queen out too early** — she can get chased around!



Opening Principles — Quiz Time!

Start strong!

1. What should you control early in the game?

- ☐ (a) The center
- ☐ (b) The corners
- ☐ (c) Nothing

2. What does castling do?

- ☐ (a) Keeps the King safe
- ☐ (b) Captures a piece
- ☐ (c) Ends the game

3. Is it a good idea to bring your Queen out very early?

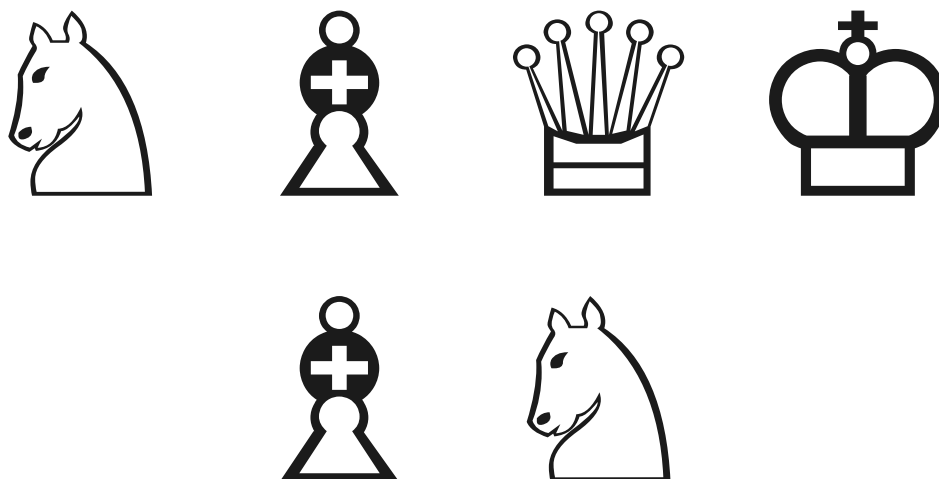
- ☐ (a) Yes, always
- ☐ (b) No, usually not
- ☐ (c) It doesn't matter

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-a, 2-a, 3-b

Color a Developed Position

Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!



These pieces are ready to battle! Color each one a different color.

Chess Etiquette

Chess isn't just about winning — it's about being a good sport! Here are the golden rules every young player should follow:

- Shake hands (or say hello) before and after the game.
- If you touch a piece, you must move it (the "touch-move" rule)!
- Never distract your opponent while they're thinking.
- Say "check" politely when you attack the King.
- Congratulate your opponent, win or lose.
- Stay quiet during tournament games — save the celebration for after!

Remember: Good sportsmanship makes you a champion, no matter the result!

Chess Etiquette — Quiz Time!

Are you a good sport?

1. What is the "touch-move" rule?

- ☐ a If you touch a piece, you must move it
- ☐ b You can touch any piece for fun
- ☐ c There is no such rule

2. What should you do after losing a game?

- ☐ a Congratulate your opponent
- ☐ b Storm off
- ☐ c Flip the board

3. Should you distract your opponent while they think?

- ☐ a Yes
- ☐ b No
- ☐ c Only sometimes

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-a, 2-a, 3-b

Famous Games in History

Some chess games are so brilliant that players still study them today! Here are two of the most legendary:

The Immortal Game (1851): Adolf Anderssen sacrificed his Queen and both Rooks to deliver a stunning checkmate with just his remaining minor pieces. It's still called "immortal" nearly 175 years later!

The Game of the Century (1956): A 13-year-old named Bobby Fischer sacrificed his Queen against a strong adult grandmaster — and still won the game! It shocked the entire chess world.

Great games teach us that chess isn't just about keeping your pieces — sometimes giving one up leads to something even better!

Famous Games — Quiz Time!

Do you remember these legendary games?

1. Who played the Immortal Game?

- ☐ a Adolf Anderssen
- ☐ b Bobby Fischer
- ☐ c Magnus Carlsen

2. How old was Bobby Fischer during the "Game of the Century"?

- ☐ a 8
- ☐ b 13
- ☐ c 22

3. What did both famous games have in common?

- ☐ a A surprising sacrifice
- ☐ b A quick draw
- ☐ c No captures at all

turn the book upside down to check your answers

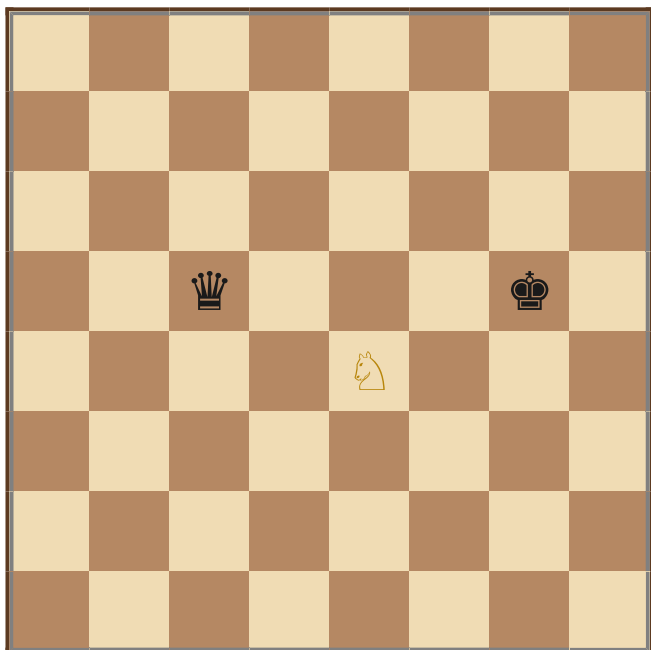
Answers: 1-a, 2-b, 3-a

Practice Puzzles

It's your turn! Find the best tactic in each puzzle below. Answers are a few pages later — no peeking until you try!

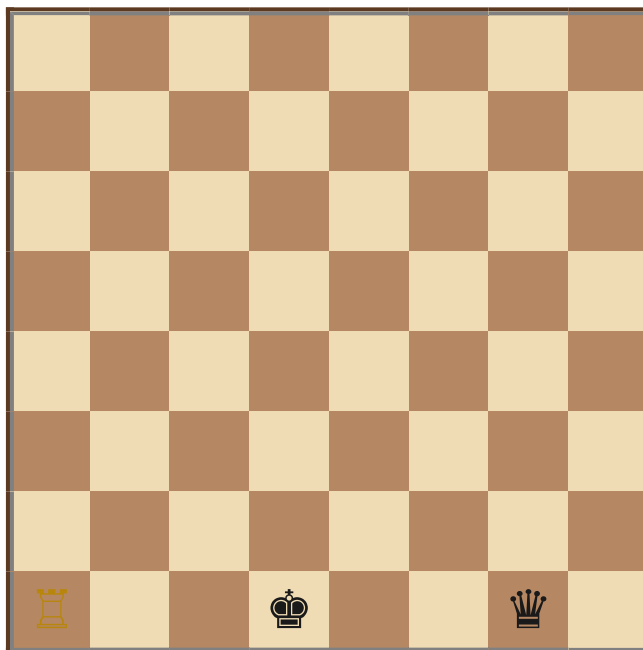
Puzzle 1

White to move. Can the Knight fork the King and Queen?



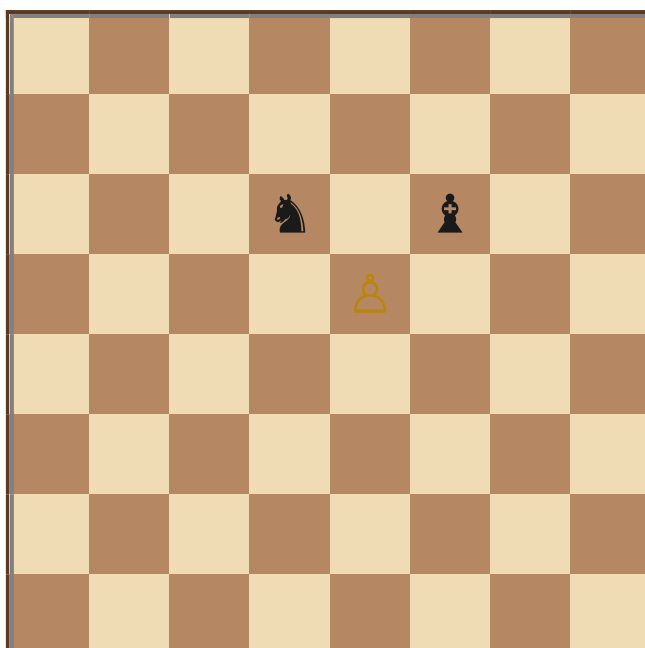
Puzzle 2

White to move. Find the skewer along the back rank.



Puzzle 3

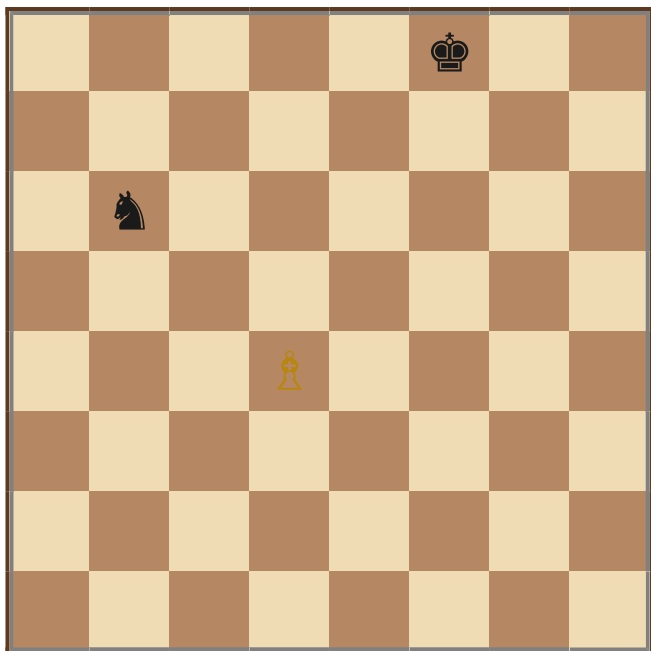
White to move. Which piece can the Pawn capture?



More Practice Puzzles

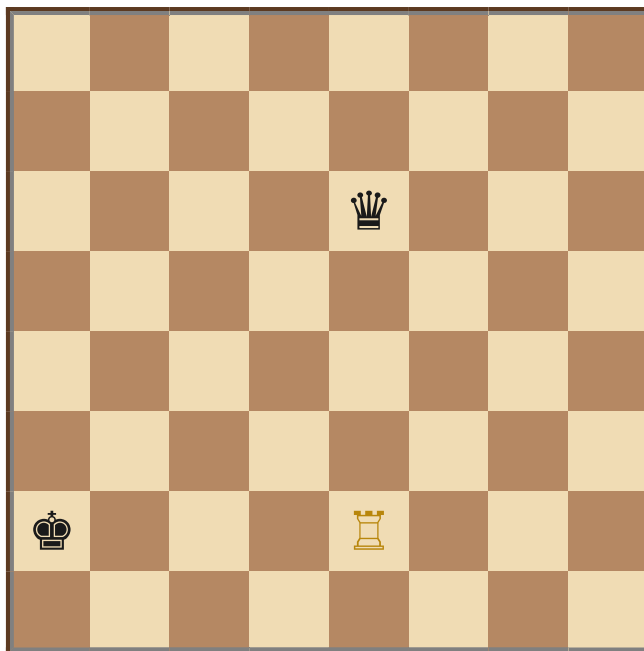
Puzzle 4

White to move. Find the pin!



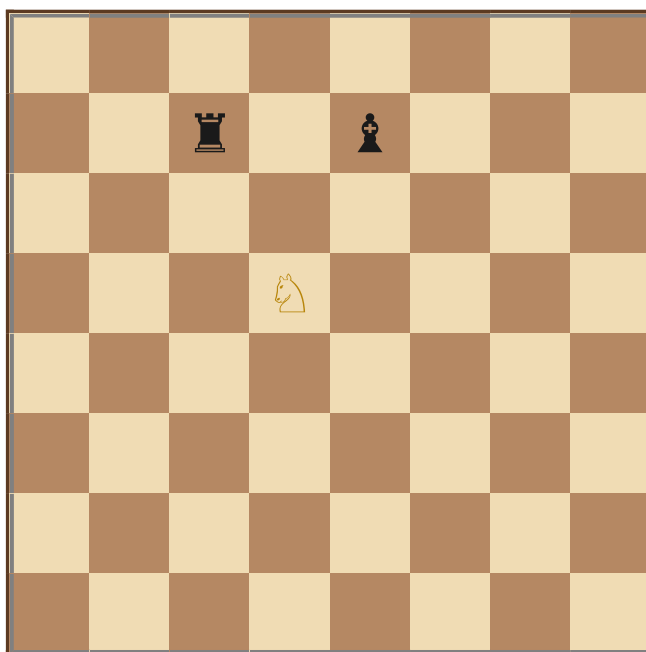
Puzzle 5

White to move. Is there a skewer here?



Puzzle 6

White to move. Which two pieces can the Knight fork?



Puzzle Solutions

Puzzle 1: Yes! The Knight jumps to a fork square, attacking the King and the Queen at the same time. The Queen is won!

Puzzle 2: The Rook attacks the King along the back rank. When the King moves, the Rook captures the Queen behind it — that's a skewer!

Puzzle 3: The Pawn can capture either the Knight or the Bishop diagonally — either capture wins material. Well done!

Puzzle 4: The Bishop pins the Knight to the King along the diagonal — the Knight cannot move away!

Puzzle 5: Yes! The Rook attacks along the rank, and if a piece moves out of the way, a bigger prize may be revealed behind it.

Puzzle 6: The Knight can fork the Rook and the Bishop at the same time — a classic double attack!

How did you do? Keep practicing — the more puzzles you solve, the faster you'll spot tactics in your own games!

Fun Chess Facts

- The longest possible chess game (theoretically) could last thousands of moves!
- There are more possible chess games than atoms in the known universe.
- The word "checkmate" comes from the Persian phrase "Shah Mat," meaning "the King is helpless."
- Chess was originally invented in India, called *Chaturanga*, over 1,500 years ago.
- The rules for how the Queen and Bishop move became standard around 500 years ago in Europe.
- Chess is one of the few games recognized as an official sport by the International Olympic Committee family of organizations.

Cool connection: Since chess began in India, players like Viswanathan Anand and Gukesh Dommaraju carry forward a proud tradition that started right there centuries ago!

Top Tips for Young Players

- **Protect your King** — castle early to keep him safe.
- **Develop your pieces** — bring out Knights and Bishops before your Queen.
- **Control the center** — the middle four squares are the most powerful.
- **Think before you move** — always check what your opponent can do next.
- **Don't move the same piece twice** in the opening unless you must.
- **Look for tactics** every single move — forks, pins, and skewers are everywhere!
- **Have fun and be a good sport** — win or lose, every game teaches you something new.

Golden rule: "A chess game is won one good move at a time. Be patient!"

ACTIVITY

Chess Word Search

Find these chess words hidden in the grid: **KING, QUEEN, ROOK, BISHOP, KNIGHT, PAWN, CHECK, MATE**. They may be hidden across or down!

K	I	N	G	X	Q	P	B
C	H	E	C	K	X	X	X
Q	U	E	E	N	X	T	X
R	O	O	K	X	A	X	E
B	I	S	H	O	P	X	K
K	N	I	G	H	T	X	G
P	A	W	N	X	X	X	H
M	A	T	E	X	X	X	X

Circle each word as you find it with a color pencil!

ACTIVITY

Match the Piece to Its Move

Draw a line connecting each piece on the left to how it moves on the right!

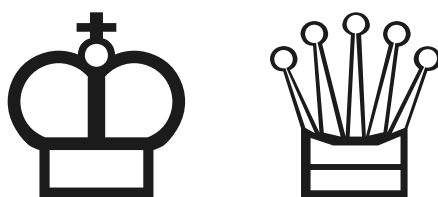
1. King	A. Moves in an L-shape
2. Queen	B. Moves diagonally only
3. Rook	C. Worth 1 point
4. Bishop	D. Moves 1 square any direction
5. Knight	E. Moves any distance, any direction
6. Pawn	F. Moves in straight lines

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: 1-D, 2-F, 3-C, 4-B, 5-A, 6-E

The Royal Court

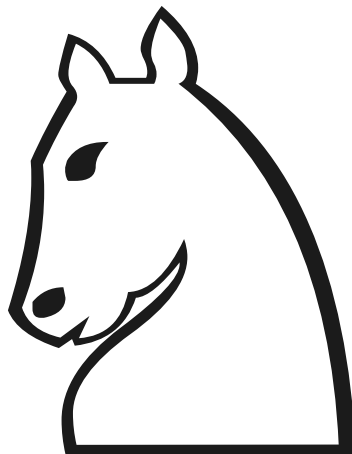
Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!



The King and Queen rule the board! Color their crowns bright and bold.

The Knight's Portrait

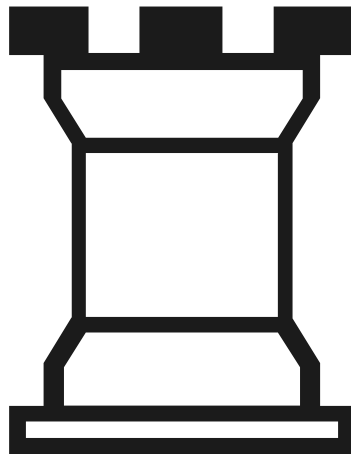
Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!



Give this brave horse a colorful mane and saddle!

The Rook Castle

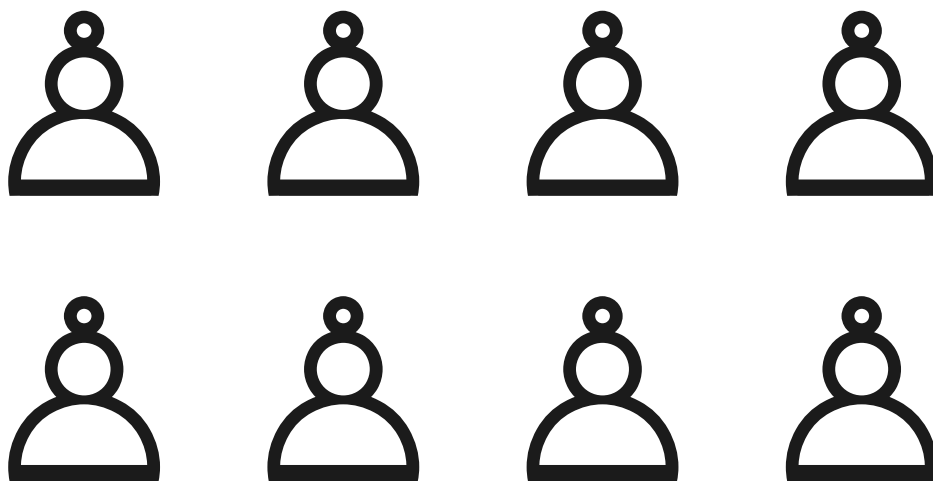
Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!



Turn this tower into your dream castle with color and patterns.

The Pawn Parade

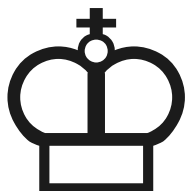
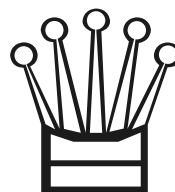
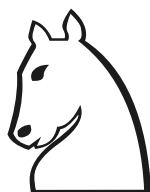
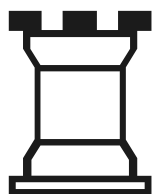
Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!



Eight little Pawns march into battle — color each one differently!

Full Chess Army

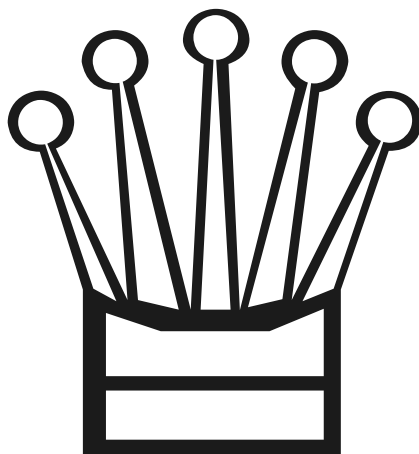
Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!



The whole back row, ready for battle! Give each piece its own colorful style.

Design Your Own Piece

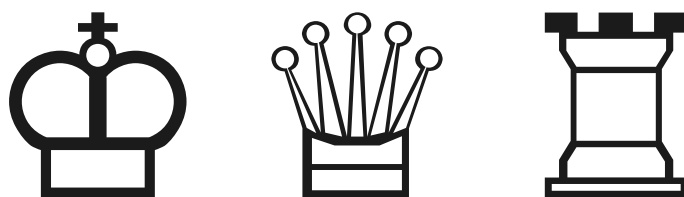
Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!



Imagine a brand new chess piece! Draw and color your own design around this outline.

Checkmate Celebration

Get your color pencils ready and bring this picture to life!



Color this victory scene — King, Queen, and Rook celebrating a checkmate win!

ACTIVITY

Fill in the Blanks

Complete each sentence using a word from the box below.

Word Box: checkmate • fork • castle • pin • promote • stalemate

- When a King is attacked and cannot escape, it's called _____.
- A Knight move that attacks two pieces at once is called a _____.
- When a Pawn reaches the last rank, it can _____ into a Queen.
- Moving your King and Rook together for safety is called _____.
- A piece that cannot move without exposing the King is _____.
- A draw where a player has no legal moves but isn't in check is called _____.

turn the book upside down to check your answers

Answers: checkmate, fork, promote, castle, pinned, stalemate

MY CHESS JOURNAL

Game Notes #2

Use this page to write about a game you played! What did you learn? What tactic did you try?



Certificate of Achievement

This certifies that

has completed *Chess Tactics for Kids* and is officially a
Junior Chess Champion!

Kunal Saha • Birati Chess Academy

ABOUT

About the Author & Academy

Kunal Saha is a chess coach and the founder of **Birati Chess Academy**, dedicated to teaching chess to young learners in a fun, friendly, and encouraging way. Through years of coaching, Kunal has helped many students fall in love with the game and grow into confident, thoughtful players.

Birati Chess Academy believes that chess builds patience, focus, and problem-solving skills that help children both on and off the board. This book was created to give every young reader a joyful first step into the world of chess.

Thank you for reading *Chess Tactics for Kids*! Keep this book handy, practice often, and most importantly — enjoy every game.



Kunal Saha • Birati Chess Academy